3 Prevention of Air pollution

If the air pollution increases at this rate, then there will be no life on the earth in the future. Future generation will be affected very badly. So we need to take some measures to avoid air pollution. Some of them are discussed below.

- Major pollutants which cause air pollution come from automobiles. Using public modes of transport can reduce the rate of pollution. We also should encourage others to use public transport.
- By reducing the usage of fossil fuels for burning we can save the environment.
- Using non-renewable energy resources like solar energy and wind energy instead of conventional energy can reduce air pollution.
- We need to reduce our usage. We can reuse or recycle few items.
- Switch off fans and lights when you are not using them.
- CFL bulbs consume less electricity. By using these bulbs we can save energy.
- Planting more trees can reduce the amount of carbon dioxide in the atmosphere.



Activity 4

Find out the common air pollutants present in your area. Discuss about the effects of these pollutants. Record your observations in your note book.



IV. Airborne Diseases

Diseases which are caused by microorganisms and communicated through air are called airborne diseases. When we breathe in air there are chances for the microorganisms present in the air to get into our body. The microorganisms which cause airborne diseases are bacteria, virus and fungi. These microorganisms are transmitted through droplets caused by coughing or sneezing, breathing and talking. Let us study about some of the airborne diseases here.

1 Diseases caused by bacteria

Diphtheria, Whooping Cough and Tuberclosis are some of the common airborne diseases caused by bacteria.

❖ Diphtheria

It is caused by the bacteria, Cornebacterium diphtheria. It generally affects the upper respiratory tract (nose and throat) and causes fever, sore throat and chocking of air passage.

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